# When Does a Home Repair Need a Permit? Ada & Canyon County

Quick reference for Treasure Valley homeowners. When in doubt, one phone call to the building department settles it.

## Usually NO permit (typical handyman scope)

- Painting, caulking, and cosmetic finishes
- Drywall patching and texture repair
- Like-for-like fixture swaps: faucets, toilets, light fixtures, outlets
- Cabinet, trim, door, and hardware repair or replacement
- Fence repair and like-for-like section replacement (height rules apply to new fences)
- Deck board and rail repair (not structural framing)
- Gutter cleaning and repair; TV mounting, shelving, assembly

## Usually YES, permit required (licensed-trade territory)

- New electrical circuits, panel work, or service changes
- Moving or adding plumbing (not like-for-like swaps)
- Water heater replacement (permit required in most jurisdictions)
- Structural changes: removing walls, headers, deck framing and ledgers
- Additions, ADUs, and garage conversions
- Re-roofs and most HVAC equipment replacement
- Gas line work of any kind

## Who to call

| If your home is in | County | Ask |
|---|---|---|
| Boise, Meridian, Eagle | Ada | Your city building dept, o… |
| Kuna, Star | Ada | Your city building dept, o… |
| Nampa, Caldwell, Middleton | Canyon | Your city building dept, o… |

## Homeowner checklist

[ ] Confirm the jurisdiction (city vs unincorporated county) before asking

[ ] Describe the actual work: "like-for-like swap" vs "moving/adding" changes the answer

[ ] HOA approval, where it applies, is separate from any permit

[ ] Permits protect resale: unpermitted work surfaces at inspection time

[ ] A pro who shrugs at permits for permit-level work is a red flag

## Learn more

- Visual guide: https://boisehandyman.co/resources/ada-canyon-permit-flow
- Article: https://boisehandyman.co/blog/ada-vs-canyon-county-permit-timelines
- Hiring guide: https://boisehandyman.co/guides/hire-a-handyman-treasure-valley